

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

(This is a two-page report. Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.)

7-0A

Each table cell will automatically enlarge as you type!

Red 2/5/01 wph

CFO-RC FILE X:

RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name): CAROLINA WREN		(Scientific Name) Thryothorus ludovicianus
Date(s) of occurrence: 1 April 2000		
Number of birds seen: One	Sex: Unknown	Plumage: Adult
Exact Location: "Ovid Woods" in the Town of Ovid		
County: Sedgwick County	Nearest town: Ovid	Elevation: 3540 msl
Length of observation: Heard bird occasionally over a roughly 10-minute period. Observed the bird for approximately 30 seconds.		Time(s) of observation: Late afternoon
Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: Chris Wood, Tony Leukering		
Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s):		
Light Conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s); position: Clear skies, facing east with sun to back.		
Optical equipment used: 8x40 Binoculars		
Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): Approximately 30 feet.		
Was bird(s) photographed? Yes (video)	If so, have you submitted photos? No	
Who took the photographs? Chris Wood		
Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: Riparian woodland along stream		
Describe the bird's behavior (flying, feeding, habits, behaviors used in identifying the Species or in supporting the identification): Observed flying and hopping around lower branches of tree while singing. Flight low and darting.		
Describe the bird in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include the overall size and shape and how you placed the bird in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird(s). Describe other important details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches or copy field notes):		
Having heard of a Carolina Wren being reported from the Town of Ovid, Sedgwick County, Colorado, Tony Leukering, Chris Wood, and I stopped to see if the bird was still present on 1 April 2000. Having arrived at "Ovid Woods" on the north side of the town in late afternoon, we began walking upstream. Within minutes, we heard the unmistakable sweet-sounding, three-noted call of "Chirpity-chirpity-chirpity-chirp (i.e. tea-kettle, tea-kettle, tea-kettle) of so familiar in the southeastern U.S. When approaching a small brush pile, a small wren-like bird darted out and flew downstream for perhaps 70 yards at which point, it began singing again. The flight was low and quick. We relocated further downstream and after a few minutes, located the bird in a small tree at a distance of approximately 30 feet. Though the view was brief, all identifiable field marks for Carolina Wren were noted. The bird was small, chestnut-brown, and very plump with a very short tail (less than the length of the wings) that was cocked up in the air at times. The bill was relatively long (roughly 2/3rds the length of the head), thin, and slightly decurved. The head was fat and gave no distinct separation between the body (i.e. thick-necked). The crown, nape, back, wings, and tail were a bright rusty-brown. A bright white supercilium extended from the fore edge of the eye posteriorly to the nape. The throat was white and contrasted with the buff-orange breast, belly, and vent. Legs appeared slightly pinkish. When perched, the bird was nervous and pumped its short neck. After viewing it for only about 25 seconds, the bird flushed and flew farther upstream again at which point we withdrew and left the area.		
Describe bird's call or song: An unmistakable sweet-sounding, three-noted call of "Chirpity-chirpity-chirpity-chirp (i.e. tea-kettle, tea-kettle, tea-kettle). The first two notes are three-syllabled while the final note is of a single syllable.		

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them:

Based on song, no other wren performs the sweet, liquid combination of that of Carolina Wrens. Marsh Wrens do have a liquid/bubbling song but the song is almost patternless and consists mainly of mellifluous trills. Tufted Titmouse has a somewhat similar type song but instead of the first two notes in the song being three-syllabled, are instead two (i.e. "Peter, Peter") with the third note being the same two-syllabled note (Peter) instead of one-syllabled as in Carolina Wren (Chirp). The presence of Tufted Titmouse in Colorado would be a rarer event than Carolina Wren as well.

The basically bright, rusty coloration of the bird is reminiscent only of Canyon Wren. Canyon Wren. Canyon Wrens (which would be more unusual at this locale) have a much longer bill, would have a more extensive white throat, would lack the white supercilium and rusty tinges to the face and crown (gray instead), and would have differed in behavior and certainly in song.

Bewick's Wrens do possess a white to buffy supercilium but is extended anteriorly into the lores. Overall coloration of most Bewick's is mud brown but can be slightly more rusty, especially in eastern birds. The Grayish breast and belly of a Bewick's also contrasts with the rusty breast and belly of a Carolina. Bewick's also have a much longer tail that may be as long or longer than the wings.

House wrens are noticeably smaller and brown overall, differ considerably in song, and also lacks the white supercilium. All other wren species differ even more notably from Carolina Wren.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species?

I have observed countless numbers of this species previously in Wisconsin, Illinois, Kentucky, Indiana, Pennsylvania, New Jersey, Maryland, Delaware, Tennessee, Georgia, Florida, Mississippi, Alabama, Louisiana, Arkansas, Missouri, Oklahoma, and Texas, and have banded many in Texas.

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): None

This report is from notes made during or after XX observation or later from memory

Date of written report: 12/07/00

Reporting observer: Larry Semo

Signature:



Reporting Observer's Address: 9054 Dover Street

City: Westminster

State: Colorado

Zip: 80021

Send report to:
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